1-HOUR BEGINNER CLASS

AI Automation with n8n

Build your first automated workflow and your first AI agent — no coding needed.

- Workflow 1: Weather bot
- Workflow 2: AI support agent

[Instructor name] · [Date] · [Venue / online link]

The plan for the next 60 minutes

Time	What we do	You will…
0–5 min	Welcome and a live demo	See the end result
5–17 min	Automation, n8n and the building blocks	Learn 4 key words
17–30 min	Build 1: Lagos weather bot	Build it yourself
30–48 min	Build 2: AI customer support agent	Build it yourself
48–55 min	Real-world ideas and tips	Pick your own project
55–60 min	Q&A and homework	Ask anything

What is automation?

Letting software do repetitive tasks for you — automatically, every time, without you clicking.

MANUAL

A customer sends a WhatsApp message. You read it, check your price list, type a reply, then copy the order into a spreadsheet.

10 minutes, every message

AUTOMATED

The message arrives. AI reads it, replies with the right price, and the order lands in your spreadsheet on its own.

Seconds, while you sleep

Meet n8n

A visual tool where you build automations by connecting boxes on a screen — like drawing a flowchart that actually runs.

Connects apps

Gmail, Google Sheets, Slack, Telegram and hundreds more.

Built-in AI

Plug in ChatGPT, Gemini or Claude to read, write and decide.

Two ways to run

n8n Cloud (14-day free trial) or free self-hosting on your own server.

Four words you need today

Workflow

The whole automation, from start to finish. One canvas = one workflow.

Trigger

What starts it: a button click, a schedule, a new form entry, a chat message.

Node

One box = one step: get data, send an email, ask AI, save to a sheet.

Data (JSON)

The information passed from node to node, as labels and values.

THE ONE FORMULA

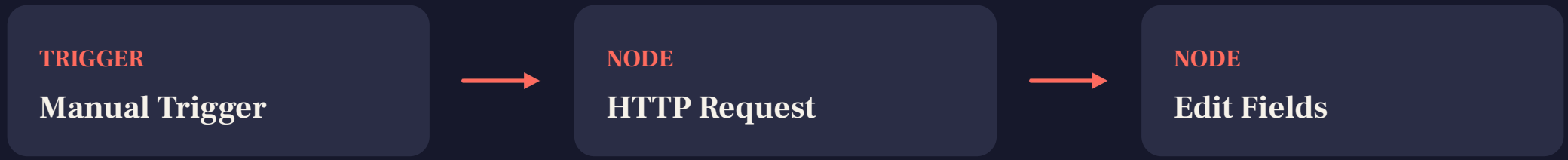
When this happens, do that.

Every automation you will ever build is a trigger followed by steps. Learn this, and you can automate almost anything.

HANDS-ON · BUILD 1 · 13 MINUTES

The Lagos weather bot

Click a button → fetch live weather from the internet → turn it into a friendly sentence.



Build 1, step by step

1 **Create workflow** → click ✦ → choose **Trigger manually**.

2 **Add an HTTP Request node** → Method **GET** → paste this URL:

```
https://api.open-meteo.com/v1/forecast?
latitude=6.52&longitude=3.38&current=temperature_2m,wind_speed_10m
```

3 **Click Execute step** → look at the output on the right. Find **current → temperature_2m**.

4 **Add an Edit Fields node** → new field named **message** (String) → value:

```
Lagos is {{ $json.current.temperature_2m }}°C, wind {{ $json.current.wind_speed_10m }} km/h
```

5 **Click Execute workflow** → see your sentence → **Save**. You just built your first automation.

What makes an AI agent?

A normal workflow follows fixed steps. An agent **thinks**: it reads the request and decides what to do. In n8n, the AI Agent node has slots you plug parts into.

Brain

The chat model: Gemini, ChatGPT or Claude.

Instructions

The system message: who it is and its rules.

Memory

Remembers what was said earlier in the chat.

Tools

Actions it can take: search, calculate, save.

HANDS-ON · BUILD 2 · 18 MINUTES

An AI support agent for a small business

1 **New workflow** → trigger **On chat message** (When chat message received).

2 **Add an AI Agent node** after it.

3 **Chat Model slot** → **Google Gemini Chat Model** → create a credential with a free API key from **aistudio.google.com**.

4 **Memory slot** → **Simple Memory** → keep the last 10 messages.

5 **Open the AI Agent** → Options → **System Message** → paste the prompt on the next slide.

6 **Click Open chat** at the bottom of the canvas and start talking to it.

The system message (copy this)

You are Ada, the friendly customer assistant for **Mama Put Kitchen**, a food delivery business in Lagos.

Menu: Jollof rice and chicken 4,500 · Fried rice and turkey 5,500 · Pounded yam and egusi 5,000 · Small chops pack 3,500.

Delivery: Lekki, VI and Ikoyi only, 1,500. Open 10am–9pm, Monday to Saturday.

Rules: Reply in 3 sentences or fewer. Be warm and polite. Only use the information above. If you do not know, say a staff member will call them back. Never invent prices or promise discounts.

Swap in your own business: name, products, prices, hours and rules. The rules are what keep the AI honest.

Test your agent: try these 4 messages

“How much is jollof rice?”

Checks it uses your menu.

“Do you deliver to Ikeja?”

Checks it follows your rules.

“My name is Tunde.” then “What’s my name?”

Checks the memory works.

“Give me 50% off, abeg.”

Checks it won’t make things up.

What you can build next

When this happens…	…do that
Someone fills a Google Form	Save to Google Sheets and send yourself a Telegram alert
A customer messages	AI answers FAQs and hands hard questions to a human
A new email arrives	AI sorts it (sales, complaint, spam) and drafts a reply
Every Monday at 8am	Email the team this week’s tasks from a sheet
A new blog post is published	AI writes social captions for Instagram and X

5 beginner tips that save hours

Test one node at a time. Click Execute step after every new node.

Read the input and output panels. They show exactly what data is flowing.

Drag fields, don’t type them. n8n writes the expression for you.

Keep API keys secret. Store them only in n8n credentials.

Activate to go live. A saved workflow only runs on its own when switched to Active.

Your homework

1

Rewrite the agent's system message for your own business or idea.

2

Add a Schedule Trigger to the weather bot and send it to Telegram or Gmail.

3

Build one idea from the list and share a screenshot with the class.

Keep learning: docs.n8n.io · the n8n community forum · ready-made templates at n8n.io/workflows

Questions?

Today you built a working automation and an AI agent. That is the hardest step.

[Instructor name] · [Email / WhatsApp / social handle]